

Dear Dr Lin,

Your manuscript, "Spatial Cluster Randomized Trials – Sampling Design with Spillover Effects & Spatial Dependence", has now been assessed.

We invite you to revise your paper, carefully addressing the comments from the reviewers and the editor. Please ensure the results are accurately reported, any overstated conclusions are rewritten and the limitations of the work fully explained. When your revision is ready, please submit the updated manuscript and a point-by-point response. This will help us move to a swift decision.

Editor Comments

"Your revised submission has been reviewed again by one of the expert external reviewers. I concur with their report; while your revised submission is improved, it has not addressed the deeper issues highlighted previously. I invite you to submit another revision, in which it will be important to think carefully about each of these problems and make changes to the manuscript to address them thoroughly."

–Michael Grayling

We recommend submitting all revisions within the mentioned deadline.

If you need more time, please contact us and include your submission ID.

Kind regards,

Vrushali Mule

Assistant Editor

BMC Medical Research Methodology

[Support contact: bmcmedicalresearchmethodology@biomedcentral.com](mailto:bmcmedicalresearchmethodology@biomedcentral.com)

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